IELTS Momentum

Elite IELTS 7.0+ · Band 6.0–6.5 to 7.0+

Student's Book · Week 1: The business world

An IELTSflow Signature Course. All texts and tasks in this book are original IELTSflow material.

How this course works

You talk, the teacher guides. Most tasks are done in pairs, threes or teams. Your teacher sets up, listens and gives feedback.

Every Sunday: a full mock test. Your writing and speaking from the mock are marked and used in the next week's clinics.

Band 7 is about precision: not more words, but the **right** words, ideas developed fully, and complex sentences with few errors.

Week 1 · Lesson 1 Reading + Speaking

Topic: Management and money · **Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced:** Unit 17 · **Exam focus:** Reading – matching headings, matching features, summary completion; Speaking – the Band 7 descriptors, Part 1

1 Warm-up: speed meeting (8 min)

Stand up. Talk to a new partner every 90 seconds. Ask **one** question each, then move on.

1 Would you rather work for a big company or start your own business?
2 What do people your age spend most of their money on?
3 Is it easy to save money in Uzbekistan? Why / why not?
4 What makes a good boss?

2 Vocabulary: business and personal finance

Word / phrase	Definition	Example
delegate (v)	to give part of your work or responsibility to someone else	Good managers **delegate** routine tasks to their teams.
stakeholder	a person or group with an interest in a business, e.g. staff, customers, investors	The decision affects every **stakeholder**, not just shareholders.
revenue	the total income a company receives from sales	Online sales now generate half of the firm's **revenue**.
profit margin	the percentage of revenue that is left as profit	Supermarkets operate on very thin **profit margins**.
overheads	regular business costs such as rent, electricity and salaries	Working from home cut the company's **overheads**.
cash flow	the movement of money into and out of a business	Many small firms fail because of poor **cash flow**, not low sales.
entrepreneurial	willing to take risks to start new businesses	Kokand has a long **entrepreneurial** tradition of trade.
diversify	to start producing a wider range of goods or services	The bakery **diversified** into catering.

Word / phrase	Definition	Example
merger	the joining of two companies into one	The **merger** created the country's largest bank.
downturn	a period when economic activity falls	Tourism suffered in the economic **downturn**.
go bankrupt	to be legally unable to pay your debts	Several airlines **went bankrupt** in 2020.
disposable income	money left after paying tax and essential bills	Young professionals have more **disposable income** than students.
frugal	careful to spend as little money as possible	My grandparents lived a **frugal** but happy life.
incentive	something that encourages a person to do something	Bonuses act as an **incentive** to work harder.
consumer confidence	how positive people feel about spending money	**Consumer confidence** rose after the new tax cuts.

Group work

Word experts: Pair A teaches words 1–8, Pair B teaches words 9–15: definition, your own example, and one **collocation** (e.g. *improve cash flow, a thin profit margin*).

Taboo race: teams take turns to describe a word without saying it. 30 seconds per word.

Practice. Complete each sentence with a word or phrase from the list in the correct form.

1 Although sales rose, the café was still short of money because of poor …….

2 During the ……, many families cut back on eating out.

3 Rather than doing everything herself, the new manager learned to …….

4 Higher taxes would reduce people's ……, so they would spend less.

5 After its biggest client left, the firm ……. and 40 people lost their jobs.

6 The farm ……. into tourism by opening a guest house.

7 A free coffee for every tenth visit is a simple ……. to return.

8 Before making the decision, the company consulted every ……, from staff to local residents.

3 Reading: Passage 2 level

Exam strategy: matching headings

1 Read the **headings** first and underline the key idea of each (not single words).

2 For each paragraph, read the **first two sentences and the last sentence** – then decide what the **whole** paragraph is about.

3 Beware of headings that match **one detail** but not the main idea (e.g. 'flat-pack furniture' appears in B, but is B about transport costs?).

4 Do headings **before** other questions on the same passage – they give you a map of the text.

Group work

Team prediction (3 min): read only the title, subtitle and headings. Predict three things the passage will say.

Solo exam work (20 min): answer Questions 1–13 alone, in silence.

Defend your answer: in threes, compare. Where you disagree, each person must read out the sentence that proves their answer. The team agrees one final answer.

Heading writers: each team writes a **new, better** heading for one paragraph – the class votes for the best.

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on the reading passage below.

Why we love what we make

Psychologists have found that our own effort can make ordinary products seem special. Businesses have been quick to take notice.

A In 2011, three researchers – Michael Norton of Harvard Business School, Daniel Mochon and Dan Ariely – carried out a series of experiments that would later give a name to a familiar feeling. In one study, some participants were asked to assemble a plain storage box from a well-known Swedish furniture retailer, while others were simply shown an identical box that had already been put together. When both groups were asked how much they would pay for the box, those who had built it themselves offered significantly more. In a second experiment, participants made simple paper animals using the Japanese art of origami. The amateur makers valued their own rather clumsy creations almost as highly as models produced by experts, while other people regarded the same amateur models as nearly worthless.

B The researchers called this tendency 'the IKEA effect', after the company whose flat-pack furniture has turned millions of customers into part-time assemblers. Founded in Sweden by Ingvar Kamprad in 1943, IKEA began

selling furniture in flat boxes in the 1950s, mainly because it reduced the costs of transport and storage. Yet the findings suggest that the hours customers spend struggling with instructions and small metal tools may bring an unexpected benefit: once the furniture is finally standing, its owners are likely to feel more attached to it than they would to a ready-made equivalent.

C The idea that effort adds value is often illustrated with a story from the 1950s. According to this account, sales of instant cake mixes in the United States were disappointing because the product made baking too easy, and housewives felt they were not really cooking. The psychologist Ernest Dichter, a pioneer of consumer research, is said to have advised manufacturers to remove the dried egg from the mix so that customers had to add a fresh egg themselves – after which, the story goes, sales rose sharply. Although the tale is widely repeated in marketing textbooks, historians have pointed out that there is little reliable evidence that this change alone transformed sales, and it may say more about how attractive the idea is than about what actually happened.

D There is, however, older and more solid evidence that people value what they have worked or suffered for. In a famous 1959 study, the social psychologists Elliot Aronson and Judson Mills invited female students to join a discussion group. Before joining, some had to pass an embarrassing 'initiation test', while others faced a mild test or none at all. All of them then listened to the same recording of a deliberately dull group discussion. Those who had endured the most embarrassing initiation rated the discussion and its members as far more interesting than the others did. The researchers explained this as a way of reducing mental discomfort: having paid a high price to join, people convince themselves that the group must be worth it.

E A related phenomenon concerns ownership rather than effort. In experiments published in 1990, the economists Daniel Kahneman, Jack Knetsch and Richard Thaler gave coffee mugs to half the participants in a group and then allowed them to trade. Those who owned a mug typically asked for about twice as much money to sell it as the others were prepared to pay to buy one – even though the mugs had been handed out at random only minutes before. This 'endowment effect' suggests that simply possessing an object increases its value in our eyes, and that effort may strengthen a feeling of ownership that already exists.

F Businesses have found many ways to use these insights. The American retailer Build-A-Bear Workshop, founded by Maxine Clark in 1997, invites children to choose, fill and dress their own soft toys rather than buy them ready-made. Sports companies allow customers to design the colours of their own trainers online, and the Danish toy company LEGO runs a website on which fans can submit designs for new sets; if an idea gains 10,000 supporters, it is reviewed by the company and may be put into production. In each case, the customer becomes a partner in creating the product, which not only increases its perceived value but may also encourage brand loyalty.

G The same tendency can cause problems inside organisations. Teams that have invested time and energy in developing their own ideas often overestimate the quality of those ideas and undervalue suggestions from outside – a pattern sometimes called 'not-invented-here' syndrome. Norton and his colleagues also found that the IKEA effect has clear limits. When participants failed to complete their task, or built something and then had to take it apart, the extra value they placed on their work largely disappeared. Effort, it seems, increases our affection for a product only when it leads to success.

H For consumers, the research offers a useful warning: the pride we feel in something we have assembled or customised may lead us to pay more than it is objectively worth, or to keep products long after better options have appeared. For managers, the message is more complex. Involving customers in creating a product can build attachment and loyalty, but the task must be challenging enough to feel meaningful and simple enough to finish. And the people who design those products would do well to remember that their own favourite ideas are not necessarily the best ones.

Questions 1–7

The reading passage has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. Choose the correct heading for paragraphs **B–H** from the list of headings below.

List of headings

i The danger of valuing our own ideas too highly
ii A furniture company lends its name to a finding
iii Evidence that effort increases value
iv Why customers are invited to design products
v A popular story that may not be true
vi Suffering as the price of membership
vii How owning something changes its value
viii Lessons for shoppers and managers
ix How flat-pack furniture reduced transport costs
x The rising price of self-assembly products
xi Why handmade gifts are appreciated

Example: Paragraph A – **iii**

1 Paragraph B ____
2 Paragraph C ____
3 Paragraph D ____
4 Paragraph E ____
5 Paragraph F ____
6 Paragraph G ____

7 Paragraph H ____

Questions 8–10

Match each finding with the correct person or people, **A–D**.

8 found that people who worked hard to join a group judged it more favourably ____

9 is said to have recommended making a product slightly less convenient ____

10 showed that owners want more money to sell an item than buyers will pay ____

A Norton, Mochon and Ariely
B Aronson and Mills
C Kahneman, Knetsch and Thaler
D Ernest Dichter

Questions 11–13

Complete the summary. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

The IKEA effect only appears when people are able to (11) ……. their task. Companies use it by involving customers in design: for example, fans can send LEGO their (12) ……. for new sets. Inside organisations, however, the same tendency can lead to '(13) …….' syndrome, in which outside ideas are undervalued.

4 Speaking: what Band 7 really means

Criterion	Band 6 (where you are)	Band 7 (where you are going)
Fluency and Coherence	Speaks at length, but with some repetition, self-correction or hesitation	Speaks at length **without noticeable effort**; linkers are **flexible**, not mechanical
Lexical Resource	Wide enough vocabulary to discuss topics; some inappropriate choices	Uses **less common** and **idiomatic** vocabulary with some awareness of style and **collocation**
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	Mix of simple and complex structures, but complex ones often contain errors	A **range of complex structures** used flexibly; **frequently error-free** sentences

Criterion	Band 6 (where you are)	Band 7 (where you are going)
Pronunciation	Generally understood; some mispronunciation	Easy to understand; effective **stress and intonation**

A simplified summary of the public band descriptors.

Part 1 at Band 7: answer + one natural extension

Part 1 answers should be **2–4 sentences**: a direct answer, then **one** extension – a reason, an example, a contrast (past / now) or a feeling.

× Too short: *Yes, I do. I like it.* × Too long: a 1-minute speech. ✓ *Honestly, not as much as I should. I tend to spend most of what I earn on eating out with friends, so by the end of the month there's rarely much left – which is something I'm trying to change.*

Group work

Upgrade challenge (teams): your teacher reads a Band 6 answer. Each team has 2 minutes to upgrade it to Band 7 (less common words, one complex structure, a natural extension). Teams read their versions – the class decides which is most natural.

Part 1 carousel: inner and outer circles. Each pair does one topic (below) for 2 minutes, then the outer circle moves. The listener gives a thumbs up for every natural extension.

Work or studies	Shopping	Money
Do you work or are you a student? What do you like most about it? Would you like to change jobs in the future?	How often do you go shopping? Do you prefer shopping online or in shops? Have you ever bought something you didn't need?	Is it important to save money? Who taught you how to manage money? Would you ever lend money to a friend?

Baseline recording: record your answers to all nine questions tonight. You will compare this recording with Week 12.

Week 1 · Lesson 2 Listening + Writing

Topic: Advertising · **Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced:** Unit 6 · **Exam focus:** Listening Section 1 – accuracy; Writing Task 2 – Band 7 Task Response

1 Warm-up: advert autopsy (7 min)

In threes: think of an advert you remember well (TV, Instagram, a billboard in Tashkent). Why does it work? Who is the **target audience**? What emotion does it use?

2 Vocabulary: persuasion and marketing

Word / phrase	Definition	Example
persuasive	able to make people believe or do something	The advert was clever and highly **persuasive**.
endorse / endorsement	to say publicly that you support a product / such a statement	Famous athletes **endorse** sports drinks.
target audience	the group of people a product or message is aimed at	The **target audience** for this app is teenagers.
brand loyalty	the tendency to keep buying the same brand	Apple enjoys exceptional **brand loyalty**.
gimmick	a trick to attract attention, with little real value	The free gift was just a marketing **gimmick**.
compelling	very convincing or interesting	The campaign told a **compelling** story.
manipulate	to influence someone unfairly or dishonestly	Some adverts **manipulate** children's emotions.
word of mouth	information passed from person to person by talking	The café became popular through **word of mouth**.
impulse buy	something bought suddenly without planning	Sweets near the checkout encourage **impulse buys**.
misleading	giving a false idea or impression	The 'natural' label on the drink was **misleading**.
aspirational	showing a lifestyle that people wish to have	Luxury car adverts are deliberately **aspirational**.

Word / phrase	Definition	Example
consumerism	a way of life focused on buying goods	Critics blame advertising for rising **consumerism**.
exploit	to use something or someone unfairly for your own advantage	Adverts often **exploit** people's insecurities.
regulate / regulation	to control by rules / an official rule	Alcohol advertising is strictly **regulated**.
influencer marketing	promoting products through popular social media users	**Influencer marketing** is cheaper than TV advertising.

Group work

Opinion line: your teacher reads statements (*Influencer marketing should be banned for under-16s*). Stand on a line from 'strongly agree' to 'strongly disagree' and justify your place using two words from the list.

Practice. Choose the correct word.

1 The free toy in the box is just a (gimmick / compelling) to attract children.

2 The ad claimed the juice was 'sugar-free', which was (misleading / aspirational) – it contained honey.

3 Many celebrities (endorse / regulate) products they have never used.

4 Small cafés often rely on (word of mouth / consumerism) rather than paid advertising.

5 Sweets are placed near the checkout to encourage (impulse buys / brand loyalty).

6 Critics say some adverts (exploit / endorse) teenagers' worries about their appearance.

3 Listening (15 min)

Listening slot: Cambridge IELTS 16, Test 2, Part 1 (form completion)

Band 7 listeners lose marks on easy questions. In Section 1, almost every mistake is about **accuracy**: spelling, plurals, numbers, or writing too many words.

Before: in pairs, label each gap: *name? number? date? noun – singular or plural?*

After: compare in threes. For every difference, decide together: spelling? plural? word limit? Then check with the transcript.

4 Writing Task 2: what Band 7 Task Response looks like

Essay question: Some people believe that advertising encourages people to buy things they do not need and should therefore be much more strictly controlled. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

	Band 6	Band 7
Position	Relevant position, but the conclusion may be unclear or repetitive	A **clear position throughout** the essay
Ideas	Main ideas relevant, but some **inadequately developed** or unclear	Main ideas **extended and supported**; may over-generalise slightly

Step 1. Paraphrase the question – three tools

Tool	Example
Synonyms	advertising ➜ **marketing / commercial messages** · strictly controlled ➜ **tightly regulated**
Word form	encourages people to buy ➜ **encourages consumption** / **the purchase of**
Structure	Some people believe that X ➜ **It is sometimes argued that X** / **X is seen by some as …**

Step 2. Generate ideas from different angles

Think about the question from different **perspectives**: individuals · families · society · the economy · businesses · the government · culture · the environment · the future.

Group work

Idea storm (6 min): each group takes three perspectives and writes ideas for **and** against on a poster.

Gallery walk (4 min): visit other posters. Put a ✓ next to the **strongest** idea on each.

Choose your position: individually, decide: completely agree / mostly agree / partly agree / disagree. The strongest two ideas for your position become your two body paragraphs.

Step 3. Develop each idea: the PEEL paragraph (Present – Explain – Example – Link/Result)

Step	What it does · Example
Present	Present one clear idea: *Advertising often creates needs that did not previously exist.*

Step	What it does · Example
Explain	Why / how – 1–2 sentences: *By linking products to status and happiness, adverts persuade people that their lives are incomplete without the latest phone or brand.*
Example	Specific, realistic: *Smartphone launches, for instance, are marketed so aggressively that many young people replace devices that still work perfectly well.*
Link / Result	The result, linked back to the question: *This suggests that stricter controls, particularly on adverts aimed at young people, would be justified.*

Task. Write your introduction and one fully developed body paragraph (PEEL). Then swap with a partner: they underline each part of the chain. Any missing part?

Week 1 · Lesson 3 Grammar + Writing clinic + Speaking clinic

Grammar: Complex noun phrases · **Vocabulary Files C2:** Unit 1, The business world · **Accuracy:** Common Mistakes at Proficiency, Units 1–2

1 Warm-up: business collocations (8 min)

Word / phrase	Definition	Example
launch a product	to make a new product available	The firm **launched** its first smartphone in 2019.
break even	to earn exactly as much as you spend	New restaurants rarely **break even** in their first year.
run at a loss	to spend more than you earn over a period	The factory has been **running at a loss** for years.
market share	the percentage of all sales in a market that a company has	The company has a 30% **market share**.
niche market	a small, specialised group of customers	Handmade suzani bags serve a **niche market**.
red tape	too many official rules and forms	**Red tape** discourages small businesses.
cash injection	a sudden large amount of money given to a business	The start-up needs a **cash injection** to survive.
hostile takeover	buying a company against its managers' wishes	The board fought off a **hostile takeover**.
the bottom line	the final profit or loss; the most important fact	Every decision is judged by **the bottom line**.
corporate social responsibility	a company's duty to act in ways that benefit society	Planting trees is part of its **corporate social responsibility** plan.

Group work

Collocation tennis: pairs 'hit' a verb or adjective (*launch, break, niche*); the partner 'returns' the full collocation and a sentence.

2 Grammar: complex noun phrases

Group work

Discovery (5 min): in groups, compare sentences A and B. Which sounds more academic? How did the writer change it? Write the rule in your own words before your teacher explains.

A *Companies spend a lot of money on advertising and this has increased.*
B **The rapidly growing amount of money spent on advertising** …

Building block	Example
Pre-modifier: adjective / adverb + adjective	a **highly persuasive** campaign
Pre-modifier: noun + noun	a **consumer protection** law
Pre-modifier: -ing / -ed participle	a **rapidly growing** market · a **carefully designed** advert
Post-modifier: prepositional phrase	the impact **of advertising on children**
Post-modifier: reduced relative clause	products **aimed at teenagers** · companies **selling online**
Post-modifier: to-infinitive	the decision **to regulate influencers**
Post-modifier: that-clause (content)	the belief **that advertising creates needs**

Rules and warnings

1 Band 7+ writers put **information into the noun phrase** instead of adding extra clauses: *The number of people who shop online has increased* ➜ **The number of online shoppers** has increased.

2 The verb agrees with the **head noun**: The **impact** of adverts on children **is** … (× *are*).

3 Don't stack more than **three nouns**: × *the city centre shop rent increase problem*.

4 **Uzbek speakers:** Uzbek puts long modifiers **before** the noun (*o'tgan yili ochilgan do'kon*). English usually puts them **after**: the shop **that opened last year** / the shop **opened last year** (× *the last year opened shop*).

Exercise 1. Rewrite each sentence with a complex noun phrase as the subject.

1 Companies spend more and more on influencers. This worries regulators. (The increasing …)

_____

2 Adverts target children. This is a serious problem. (The targeting …)

_____

3 Some people believe that money brings happiness. This belief is widespread. (The belief …)

_____

4 Small businesses face a lot of rules. This discourages new entrepreneurs. (The amount of red tape …)

_____

5 The government decided to ban junk food adverts. The decision was popular. (The decision …)

_____

Exercise 2. Find and correct the mistake.

1 The effect of adverts on young children are worrying.

2 Products aiming at teenagers are often sugary.

3 The decision of banning the advert was criticised.

4 There is a belief which advertising creates needs.

5 It was a carefully design campaign.

Group work

Noun phrase race: teams get a simple sentence (*Prices rose.*). Add information **only inside the noun phrase** – one word or phrase per turn. The longest **correct and natural** sentence wins.

3 Writing clinic: Lesson 2 paragraphs

Peer review first – Band 7 Task Response checklist

☐ The introduction paraphrases the question and gives a **clear position** (e.g. *I largely agree that …*).
☐ Each body paragraph has **one** main idea with a full **PEEL** chain.
☐ The example is **specific** (not *for example, many people*).
☐ The position does not change between paragraphs.
☐ At least one complex noun phrase (*the growing influence of …*).

Task. Swap paragraphs. Tick the checklist and write **one** question that would help your partner develop the idea further. Then rewrite your paragraph.

4 Speaking clinic: Parts 1 and 2

Describe a successful businessperson you know or have heard about.

You should say:
• who this person is
• what business they run
• how they became successful
and explain what you think of this person.

Group work

Triads: candidate, examiner (times 1 min prep + 2 min talk), observer (Band 7 checklist below). Swap after each round.

Follow-up: the examiner asks one Part 1 question from Lesson 1 before the card.

Observer checklist	✔ / ✖
Spoke for the full 2 minutes without long pauses	
At least three words or collocations from this week	
At least two complex structures (noun phrase, relative clause …)	
Natural linkers – not 'and then … and then'	
Clear word stress on key words	

5 Accuracy slot: Common Mistakes at Proficiency, Units 1–2

Group work

Be the teacher: each pair corrects two sentences and explains the mistake to the class in one sentence.

1 The company has made a big benefit this year.
2 She is responsible of the marketing department.
3 The informations about the product were misleading.
4 He has been working here since three years.
5 Despite of the downturn, profits rose.
6 The advertising are everywhere nowadays.

Week 1 · Homework (3–4 hours a day)

Day	Tasks
Day 1 (after L1)	Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced Unit 17 · Unit 21 (Learning vocabulary): set up your vocabulary notebook · **Baseline recording** of the nine Part 1 questions · One timed reading passage (Cambridge IELTS 17, 20 min)
Day 2	Grammar Exercise 3 below · 10 sentences with this week's words, each with a collocation · Cambridge IELTS 17 Listening Section 1 + spelling check
Day 3 (after L2)	Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced Unit 6 · **Writing: full essay on the advertising question (40 min, 250+ words)**
Day 4	Record a Part 2 + Part 3 set (below) and send it to your teacher · Reading: one passage + 10 paraphrases log
Day 5 (after L3)	Rewrite your essay after the clinic · Vocabulary Files C2 Unit 1 exercises · Common Mistakes at Proficiency Units 1–2
Day 6	Review all 40 words and collocations · Rest before the **Sunday mock**

Grammar Exercise 3. Write five sentences about business or advertising in Uzbekistan. Each must start with a complex noun phrase of at least five words.

Speaking Part 2 + Part 3 (record and send)

Describe an advertisement that persuaded you to buy something.

You should say:

- what was advertised
- where you saw the advertisement
- what it showed

and explain why it persuaded you.

Then answer: (1) Why are some adverts more effective than others? (2) Should advertising aimed at children be banned? (3) How has advertising changed with social media?